

■ Block

`Block[{ $x_1$ ,  $x_2$ , ...}, expr]` specifies that *expr* is to be evaluated with the symbols x_i taken as local variables.

`Block[{ $x_1 = v_1$ , ...}, expr]` defines initial values for local variables.

The initial values specified for local variables are found before the variables are “localized”. As a result, the initial values of different local variables are therefore effectively assigned in parallel. ■ A local variable *x* is represented by the same *symbol* as a global *x*. The two are considered identical in pattern matching or `==` comparisons. Any values of the global *x* are, however, removed when the local *x* is created, and are restored when the local *x* is destroyed. ■ `Block` has attribute `HoldAll`. ■ See page 252. ■ See also: `CompoundExpression`.